

Air passes out through the nose and mouth

Lungs shrink as the chest gets smaller

IN CONTROL

The rate of breathing is controlled automatically by the brain stem at the base of the brain. During exercise, such as running, the breathing rate increases to get extra oxygen to the hard-working muscles.



Diaphragm relaxes and is pushed upward into a dome shape by organs below

... Air out

The diaphragm and intercostal muscles relax so that the ribs move downward and inward. This squeezes the lungs, pushing air out of the body.